



Clear Desks and Clear Screens

Name:		Grade:	
Date completed:		Approved by:	
Valid for:		Signature:	

Clear Desks and Clear Screens



Welcome to this module on
CLEAR DESK AND CLEAR SCREEN POLICY

Clear Desks and Clear Screens

Overview

Maintaining a clean desk, or a clear computer screen is important – both from a productivity and security perspective.

An uncluttered desk:



Helps you organise your work materials and time is not lost locating stuff



Secures organisational data against theft



Can help control accidents such as fires (loose items catch fire easily)

Clear Desks and Clear Screens

Learning objectives



In this module, you will learn:

- The need for a Clear Desk and Clear Screen Policy
- Security concerns that arise when the policy is not adhered to
- Best practices to follow



Clear Desks and Clear Screens

Why do we need a policy?

The clear desk and clear screen policy is necessary to ensure that sensitive information - in both digital and physical forms, and even assets such as laptops, mobile phones, tablets - is safe and secure.

Such information or assets should not be left unguarded at personal or public workspaces, and you should exert caution while taking a break or leaving work for the day.



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Why do we need a policy?



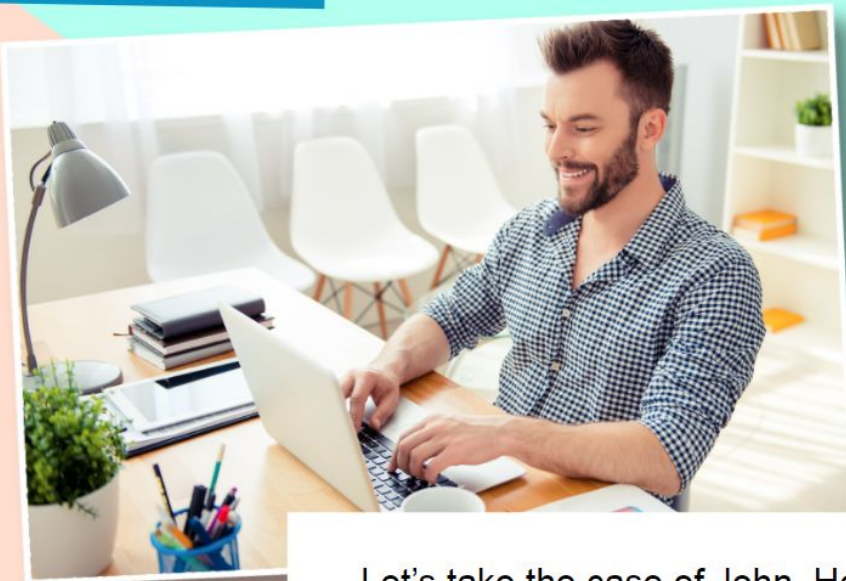
Information and assets are vulnerable even in your own workspace due to negligence of the information owner and custodian, and organisations depend heavily on the adoption of a clear desk and clear screen policy as one of the strategies in mitigating the information security risk from end users.



What, then, are these security risks? Let's find out!

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Security concerns

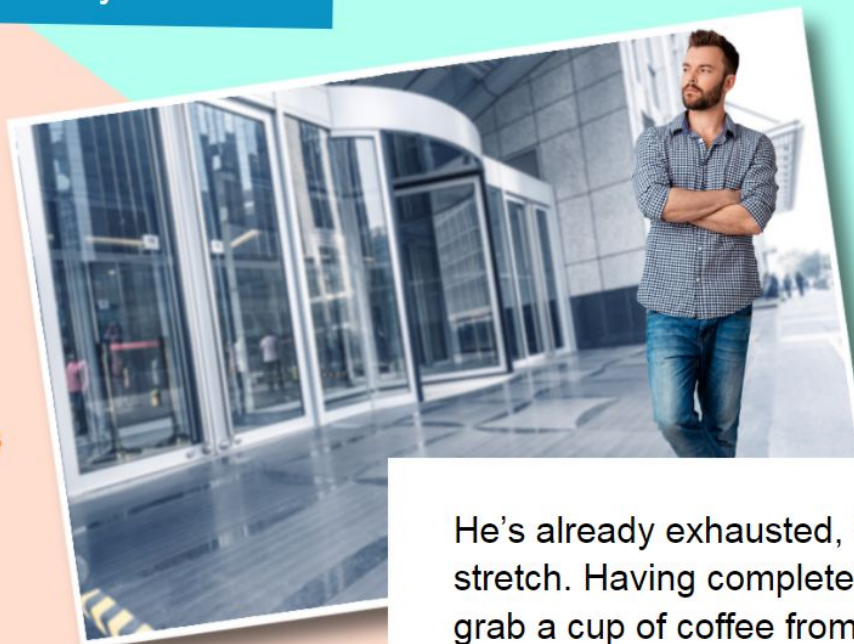


Let's take the case of John. He has an important presentation today, related to the company financials.

In fact, just so that he could finish the presentation well on time, he came in early to work on it – and now he's finally done with it, with a couple of hours to spare!

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Security concerns



He's already exhausted, having worked four hours at a stretch. Having completed the presentation, he decides to grab a cup of coffee from the café across the street.

Here's John, stepping out of office for a quick caffeine fix...

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Security concerns

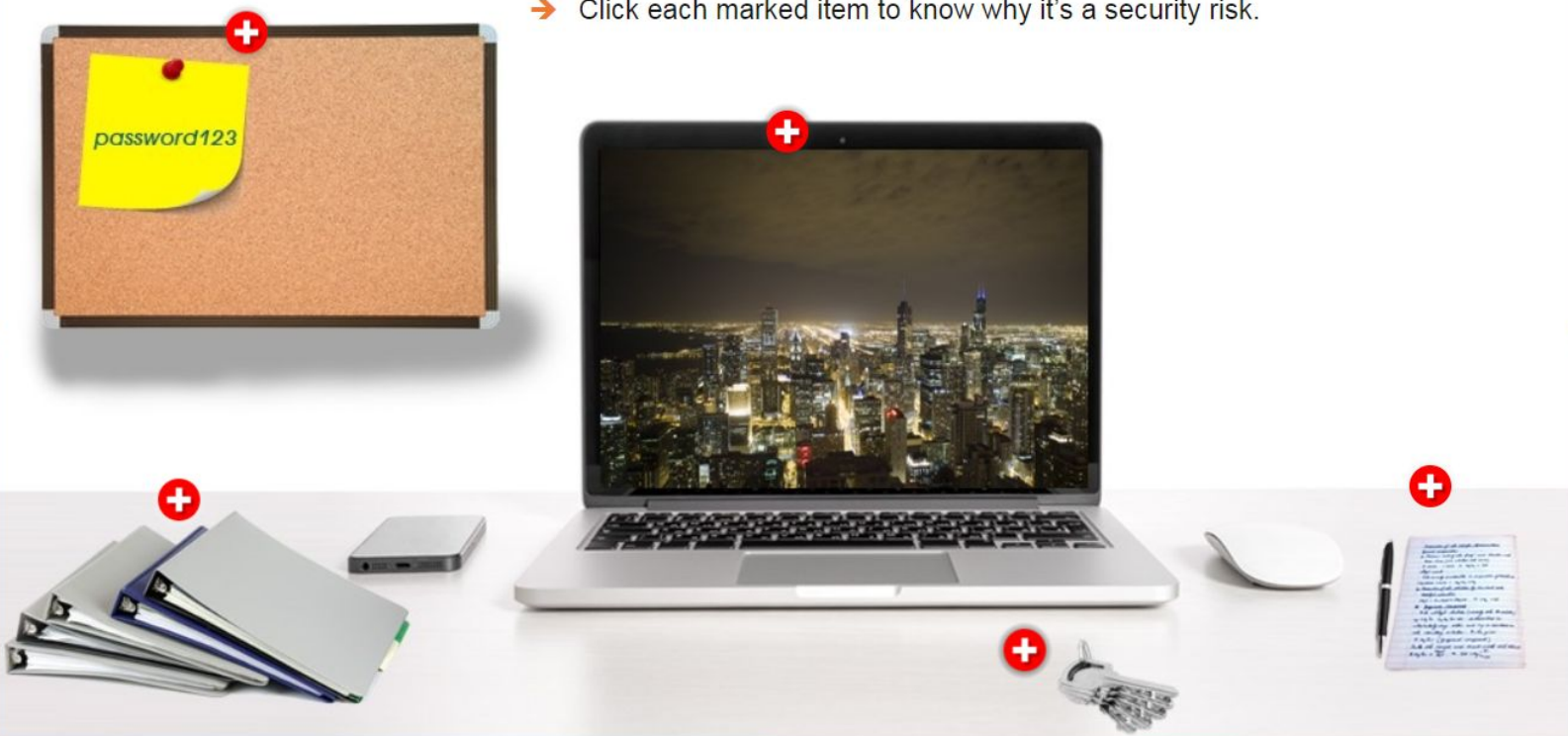


And here's his workspace, all cluttered with VERY IMPORTANT information. Oh, John! How could you?!

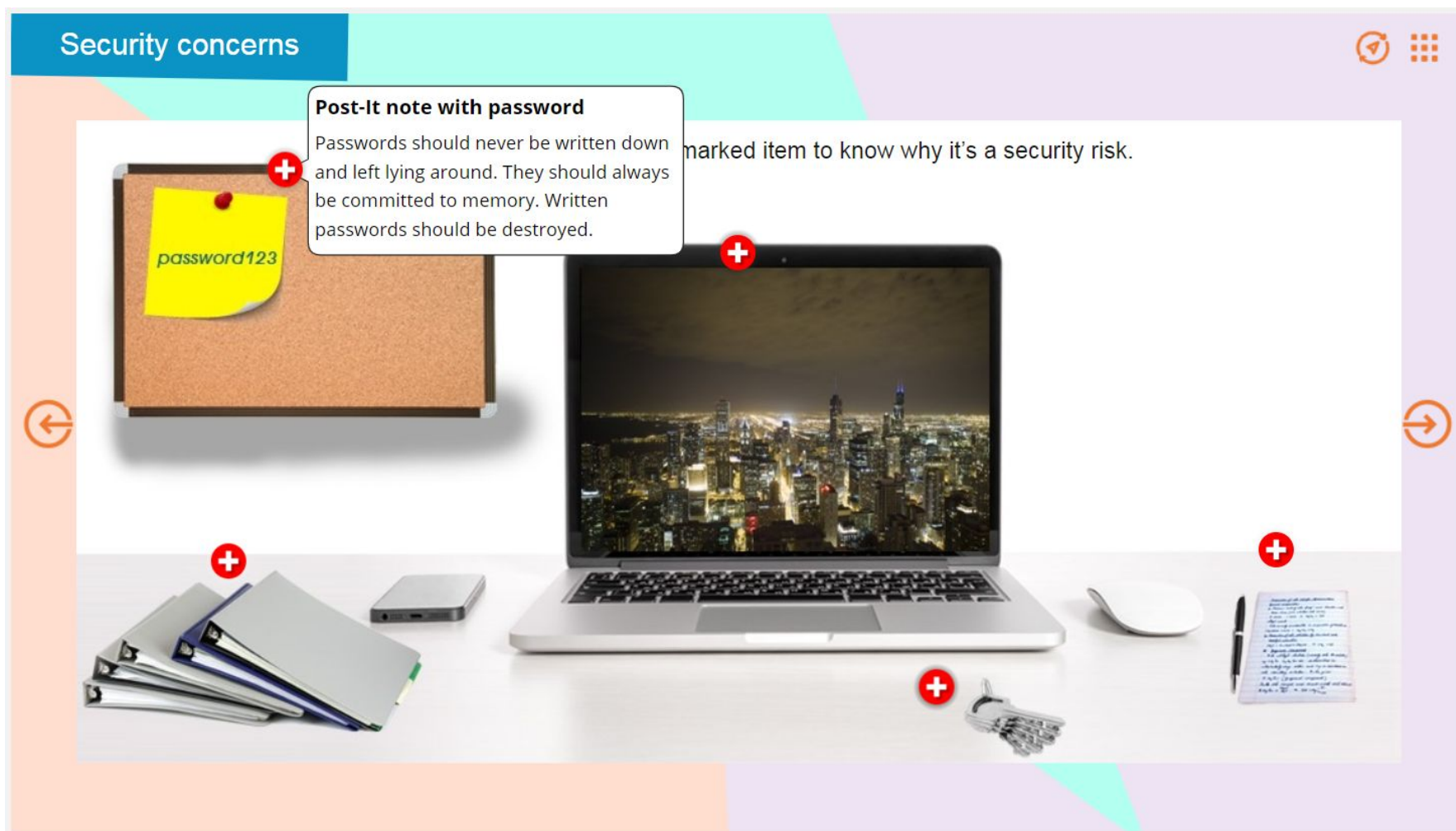
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Security concerns

→ Click each marked item to know why it's a security risk.



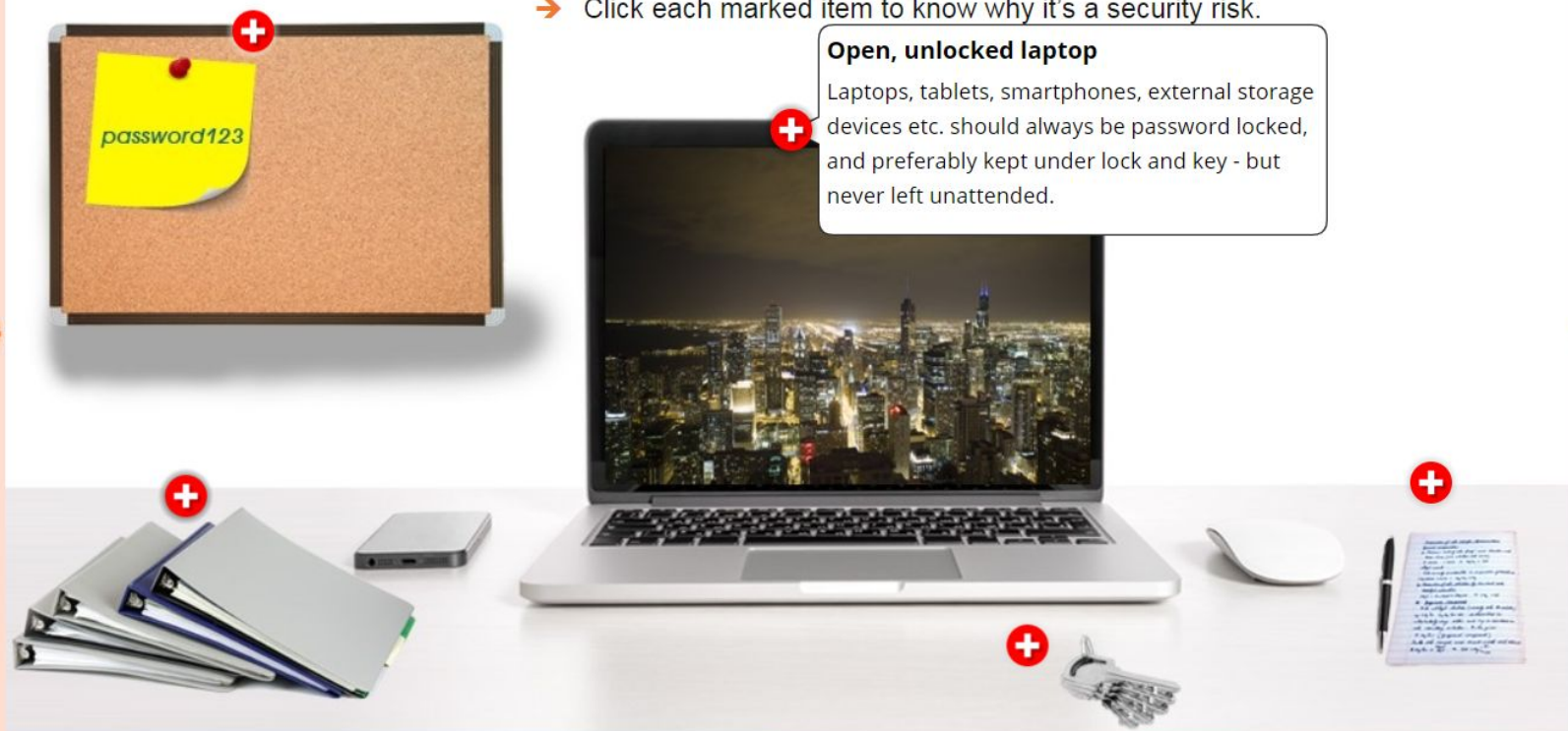
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Security concerns

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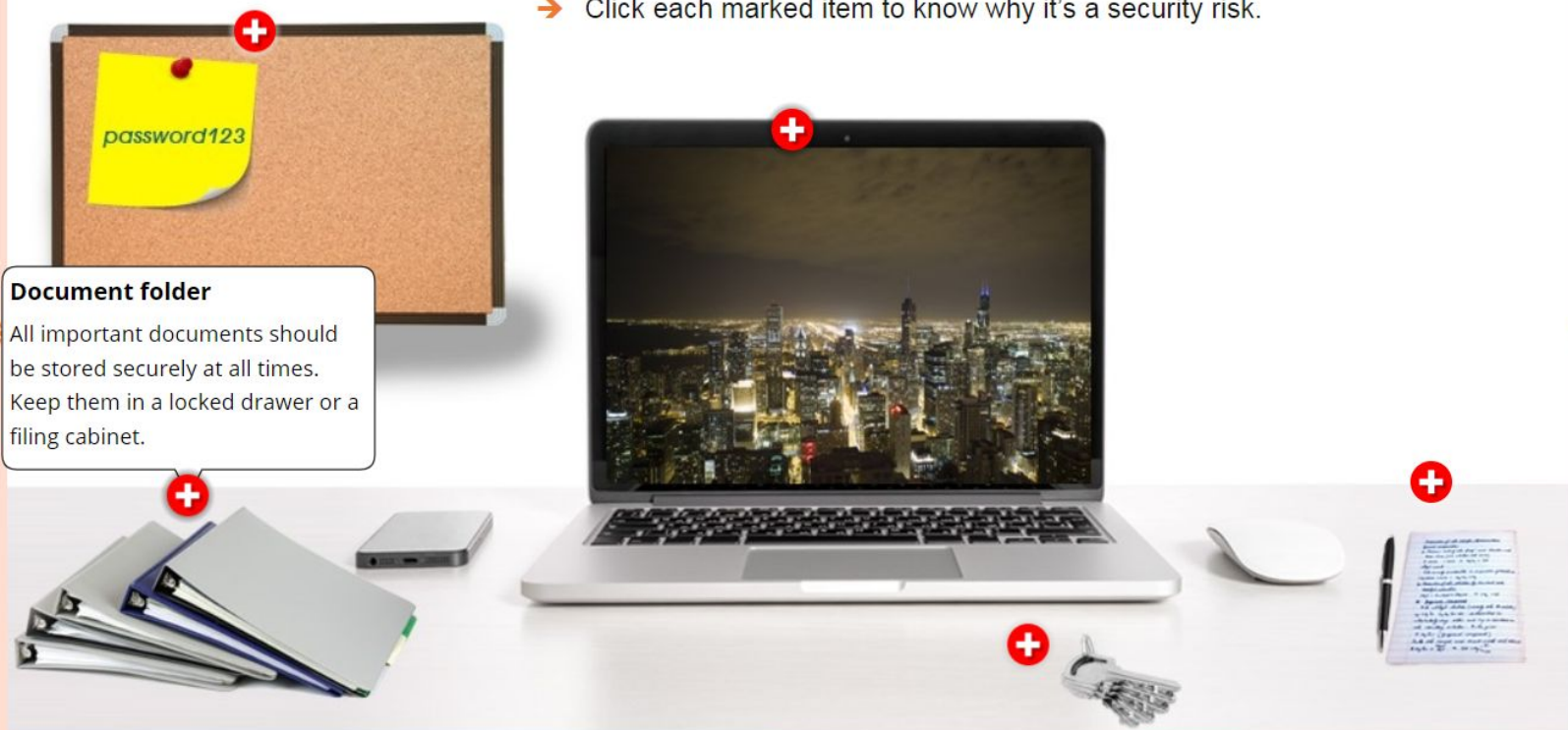


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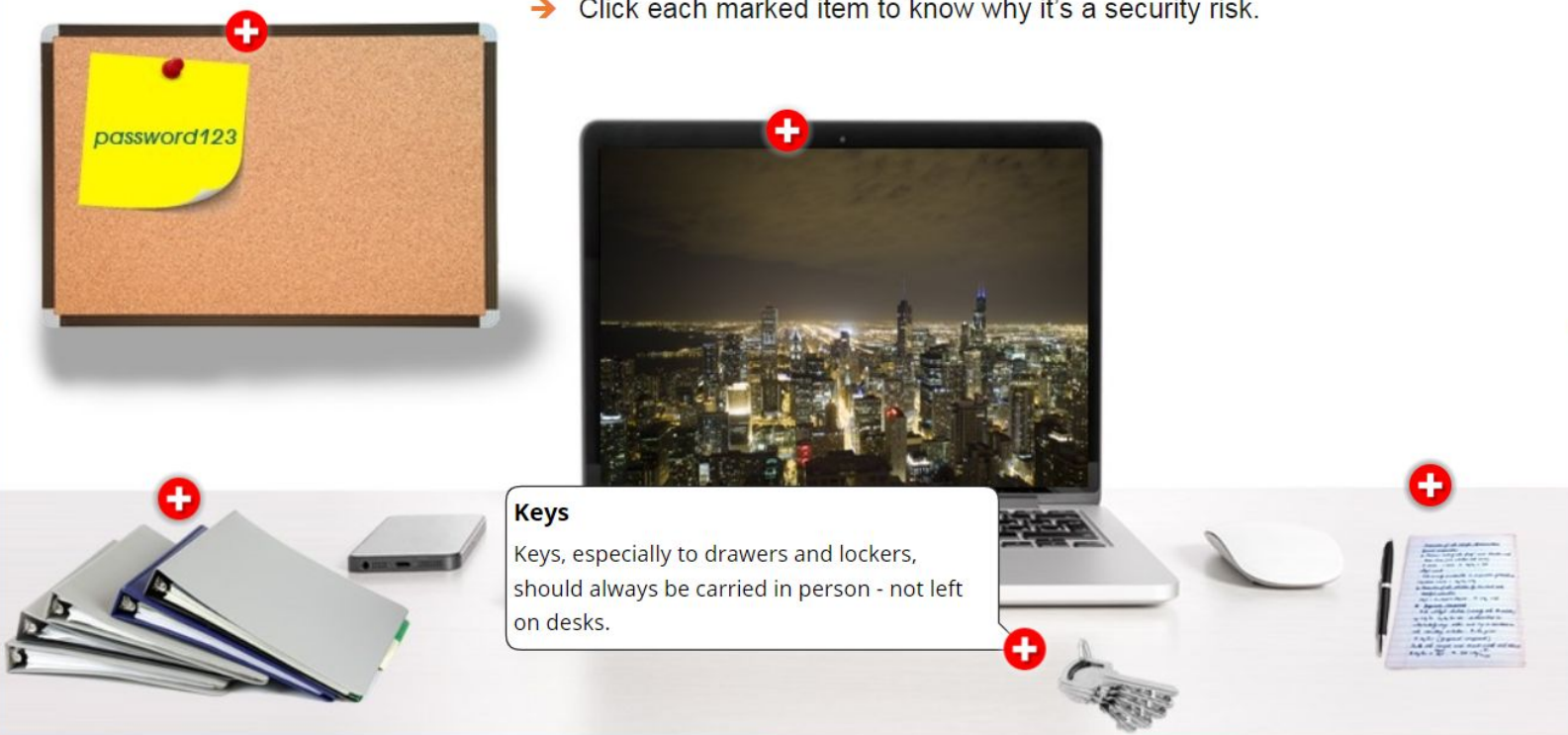
Document folder

All important documents should be stored securely at all times. Keep them in a locked drawer or a filing cabinet.

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Security concerns

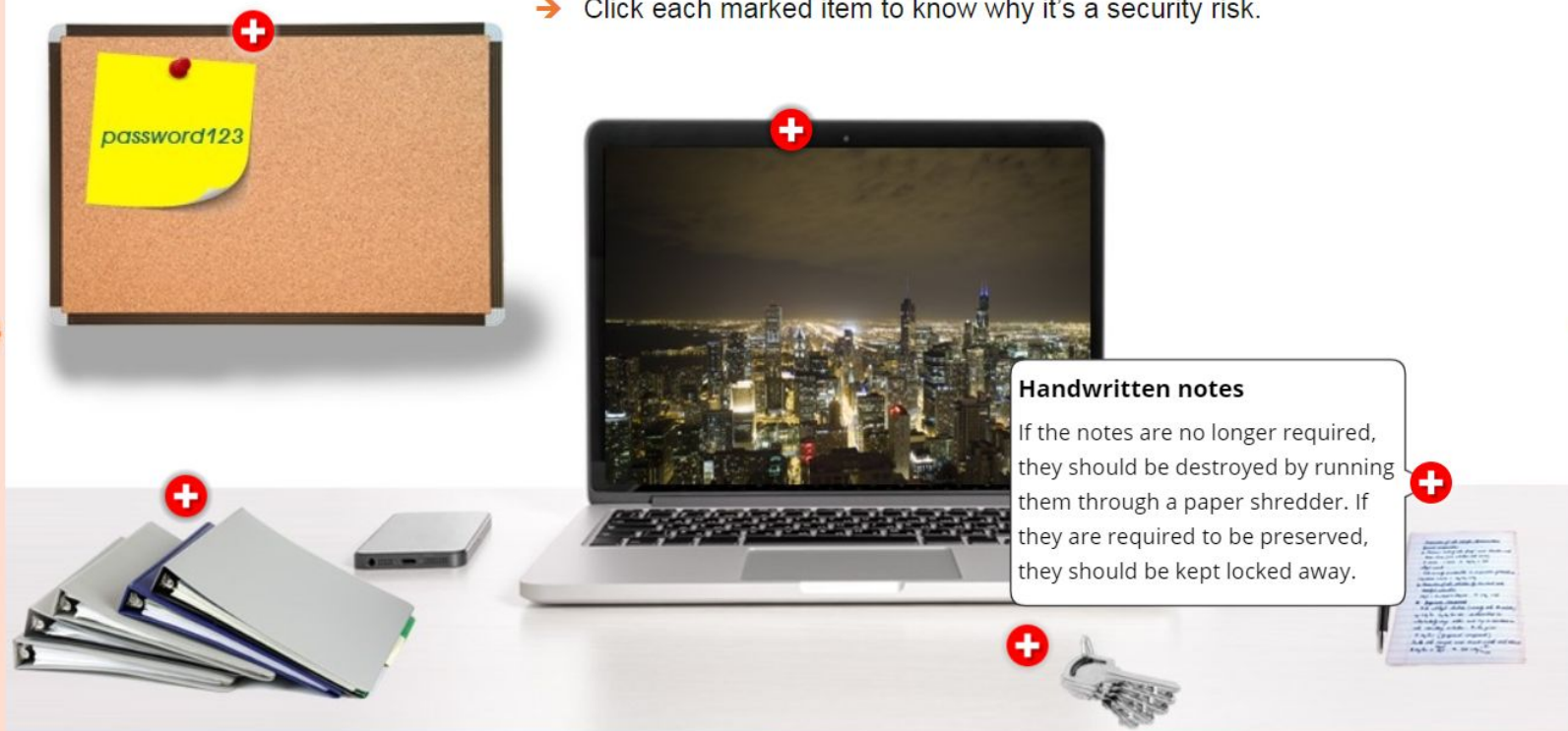
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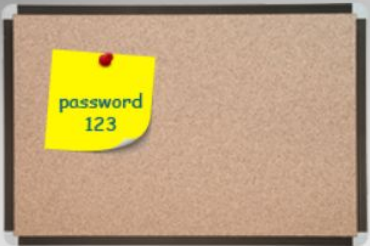
Security concerns

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Let's help John out



→ Can you secure each item by dragging it to the correct security means?



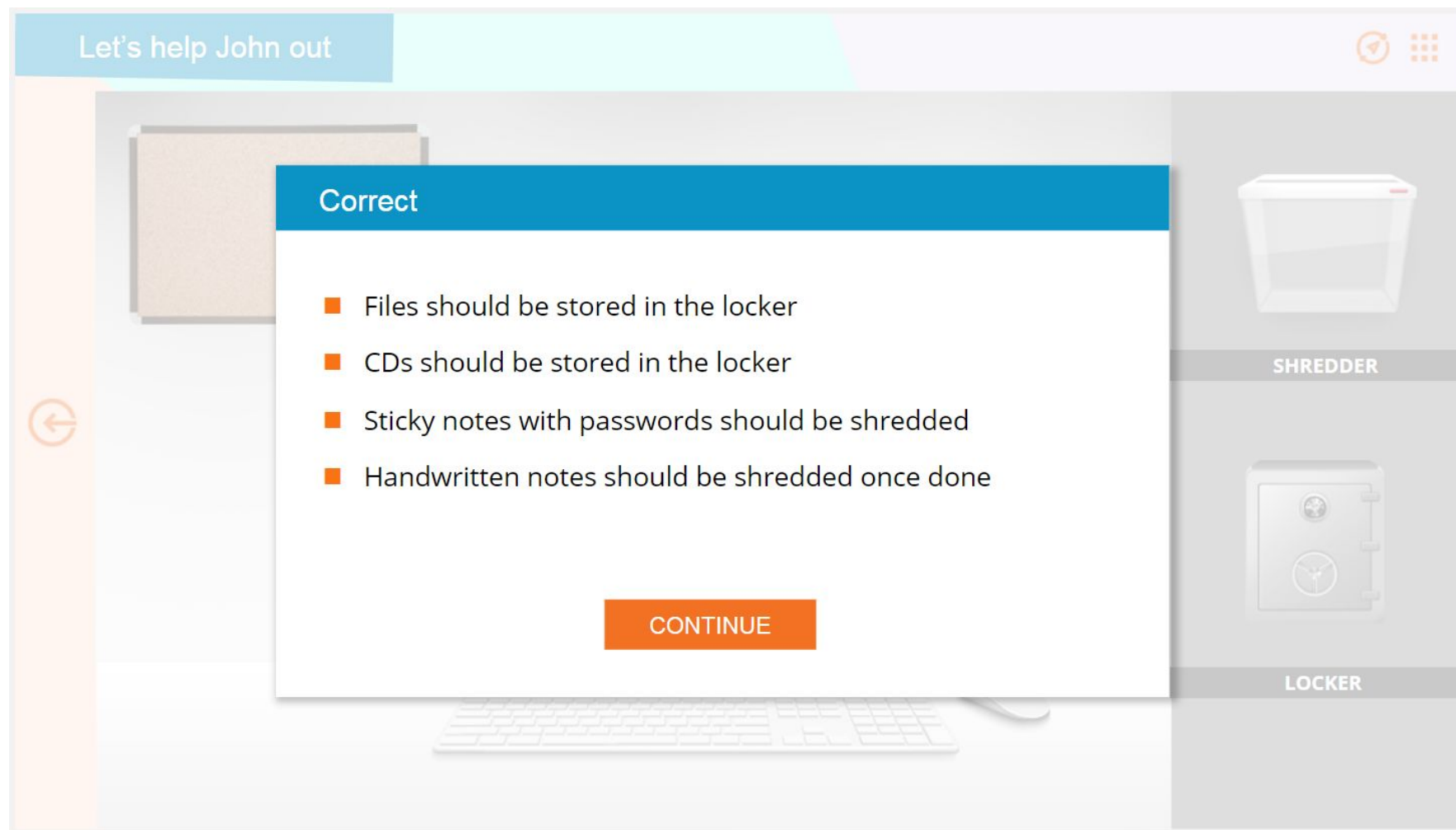


SHREDDER



LOCKER

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Let's help John out



Great! Now that you have created the desk, let's focus on the computer. What should John have done?



Lock the computer

Leave it as it is

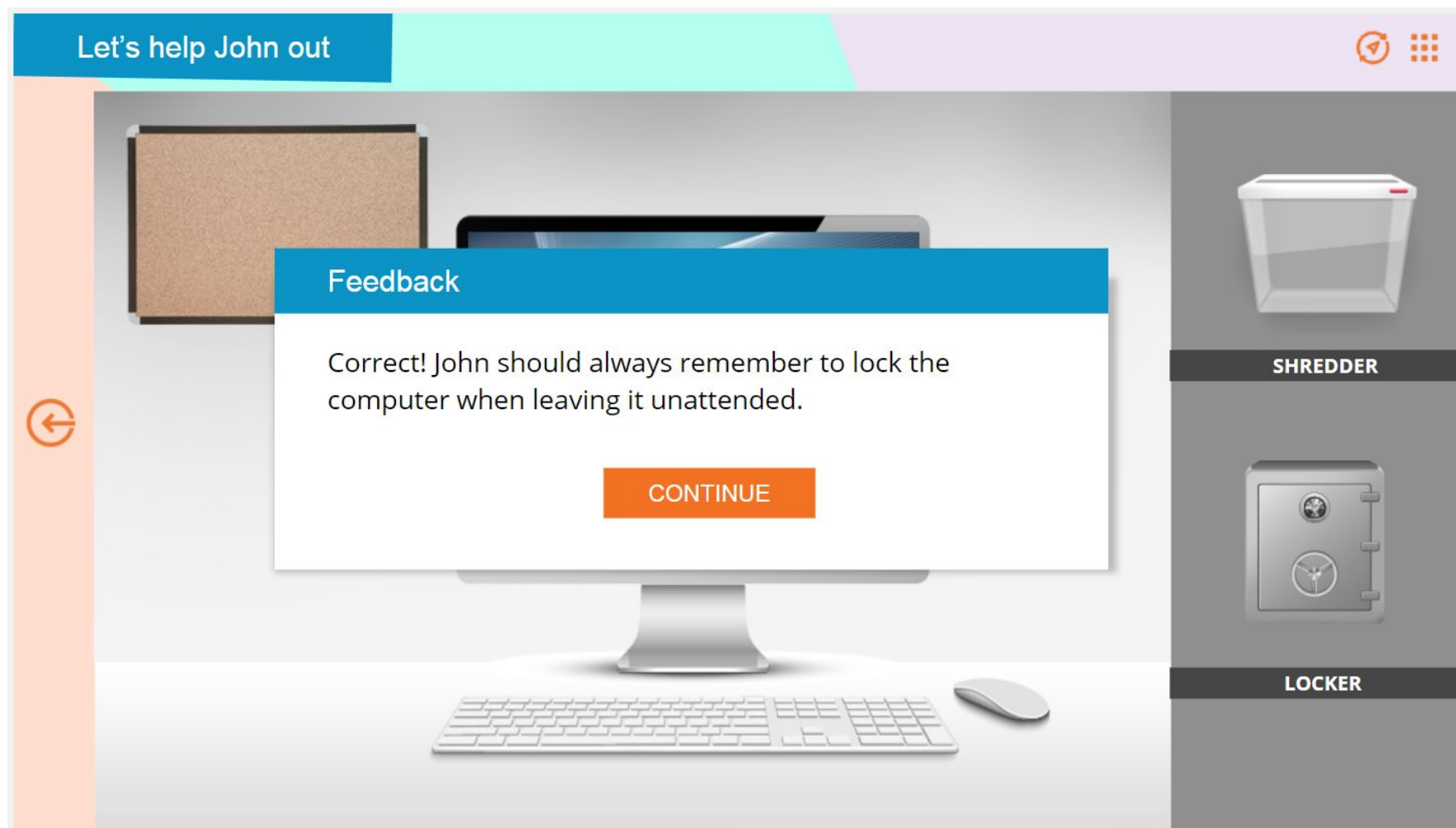


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Clear Desks and Clear Screens

Benefits of a clear desk and a clear screen

Here are some benefits of a clear desk and clear screen policy.

➔ Click each element to know more about it.



Save Time
and Money



Make Good
Impressions



Discourages
Prying Eyes



Reduce
Stress



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A clean desk policy will encourage employees to use digital versions of documents, significantly reducing your organisation's costs of paper, ink toner, and printer maintenance.

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A clean and tidy workspace makes your organisation look efficient and presentable to anyone who decides to visit, including the auditors and also helps to demonstrate the end user's security awareness!

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Employees unintentionally leave sensitive information on their desk and computer desktop. Post-it notes are usually the worst culprit, containing names, phone numbers, and even user names and passwords visible in plain view. These habits encourage disgruntled employees, cleaning crews, and maintenance staff to view information they should not have access to and may lead to corporate espionage.

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When your employees are organised they can spend more time concentrating on work rather than feeling stressed because they can't find a report due in the next 10 minutes. Thereby, increasing their productivity.

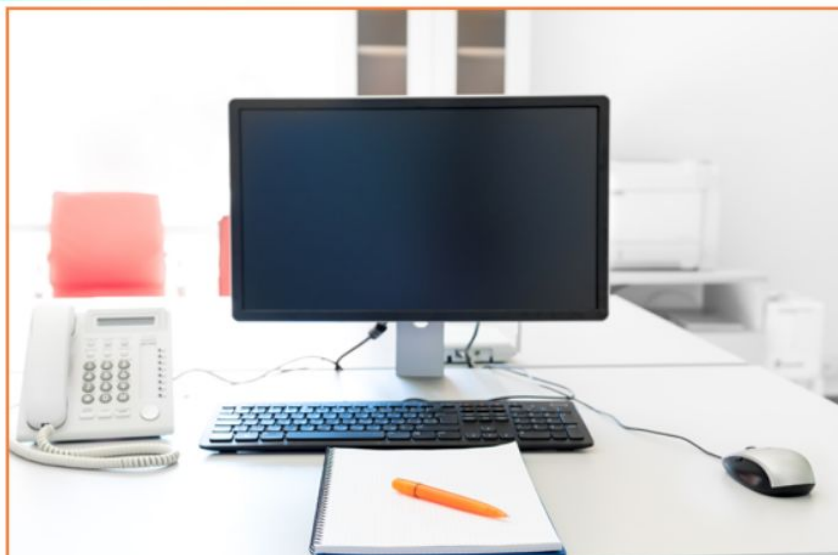
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Some best practices

- Clear your desk and lock your computer, while leaving office
- Lock all drawers and file cabinets that contain highly confidential and sensitive information while leaving office
- Ensure safety of all physical and digital information, and assets
- Shred documents you no longer require

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Conclusion



That brings us to the end of this module. Now that you have learnt the importance of a clear desk and clear screen policy, you can help reduce data security risks in your organisation!

Take this quiz to check what you have learnt.

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Is the following statement true, or false?

It is absolutely fine to leave your computer screen unlocked in your own workspace, even when you are away.

- ☐ True
- ☐ False

SUBMIT

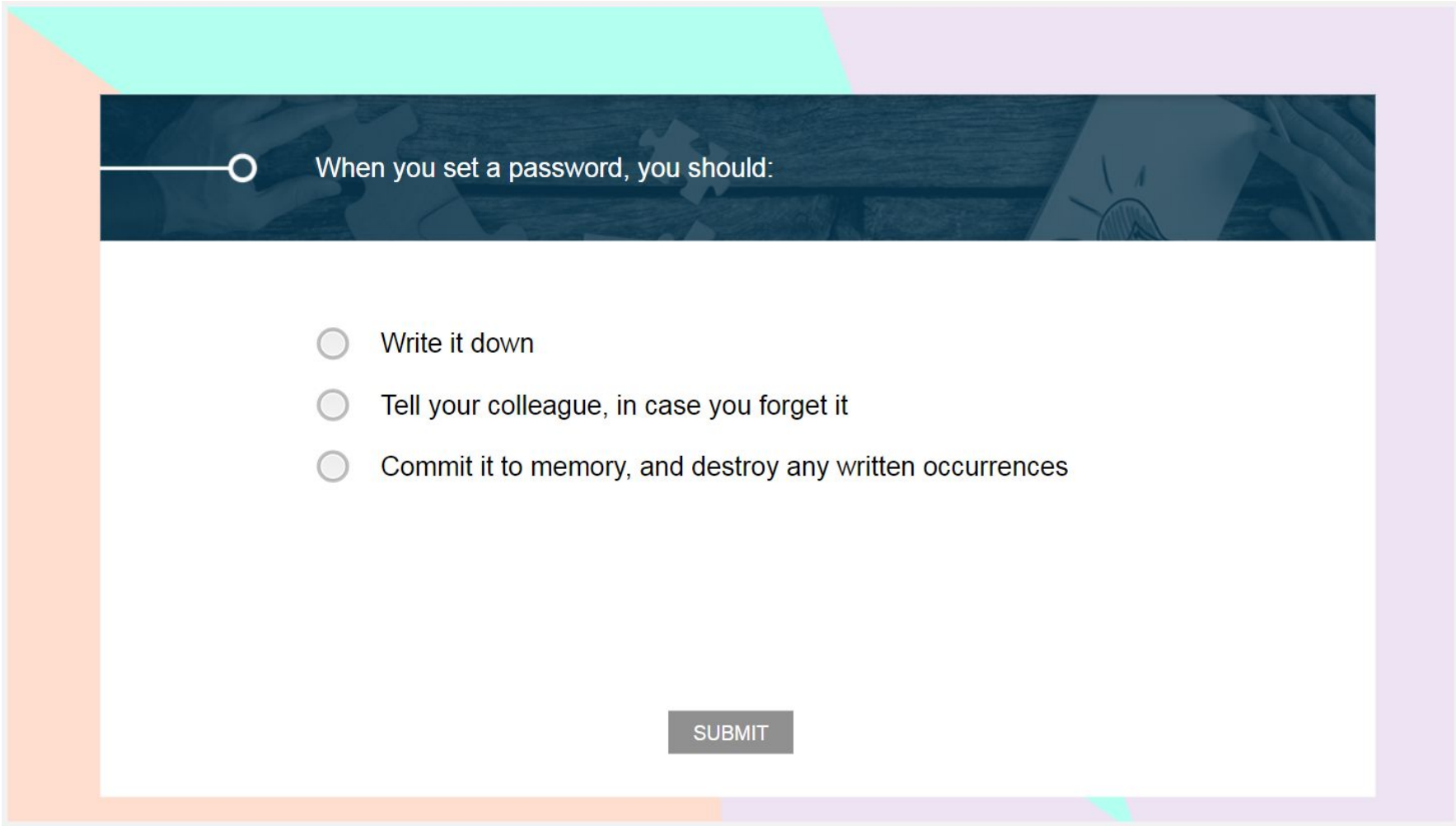
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You are working with some confidential documents, and you receive an urgent call to meet your manager. What should you do?

- ☐ Turn the pages over so nobody can read them
- ☐ Lock the documents away in your drawer, despite the emergency
- ☐ Ask your colleague to look after them while you are gone

SUBMIT

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When you set a password, you should:

- ☐ Write it down
- ☐ Tell your colleague, in case you forget it
- ☐ Commit it to memory, and destroy any written occurrences

SUBMIT

Clear Desks and Clear Screens



Before leaving office for the day, you should:

- ☐ Keep the next day's work documents stacked on your desk
- ☐ Keep your computer unlocked so others can use it if necessary
- ☐ Switch off/lock your computer, and clear your desk of all documents

SUBMIT

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If there's an important document you no longer require, you should:

- ☐ Keep it, so you can use the blank, reverse side for writing notes
- ☐ Crumple it and throw it in the wastepaper basket
- ☐ Shred it

SUBMIT

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You have successfully worked your way through this module.

EXIT